ascentium

Startup toolkit

United Kingdom

Setting up and running a private limited company in England, Wales, Scotland or Northern Ireland.

Inside: the company at a glance · your first 90 days · the annual compliance calendar · are you an SME? · the documents to gather · how Ascentium helps

Mock toolkit prepared for a concept prototype. Not legal, tax or financial advice.
Information as at November 2026. Verify figures with the relevant authority before relying on them.

1. Your company at a glance

Item	What applies
Entity	Private company limited by shares (Ltd)
Registry	Companies House
Incorporation fee	£100 for an online application
Directors	At least one director who is a natural person; directors must verify their identity with Companies House
Registered office	An appropriate address in the jurisdiction of registration
People with significant control	A PSC register must be kept and filed
Corporation tax	19% small profits rate up to £50,000, 25% main rate above £250,000, with marginal relief between
VAT	Registration is required once taxable turnover passes £90,000

2. Your first 90 days

Tick these off in order. Your Ascentium dashboard tracks each one and Ascentia will remind you before anything falls due.

- ☐ **Incorporate**
  File with Companies House and receive your certificate of incorporation.
- ☐ **Verify identities**
  Directors and PSCs complete identity verification.
- ☐ **Register for Corporation Tax**
  Within 3 months of starting to do business.
- ☐ **Open a business account**
  Most banks onboard UK companies online.
- ☐ **Hiring?**
  Register as an employer with HMRC before your first payday and set up auto-enrolment.
- ☐ **Check VAT**
  Track rolling 12-month turnover against the threshold.

3. Annual compliance calendar

The recurring obligations most small private companies meet each year. Exact dates depend on your financial year-end and on notices issued by the authorities.

Obligation	When	Authority
Confirmation statement	At least once every 12 months	Companies House
Annual accounts	9 months after year-end (first accounts: 21 months after incorporation)	Companies House
Corporation Tax payment	9 months and 1 day after the end of the accounting period	HMRC
Company Tax Return (CT600)	12 months after the end of the accounting period	HMRC
VAT returns	Quarterly, 1 month and 7 days after the period	HMRC
PAYE / RTI	On or before each payday	HMRC

4. Are you an SME?

For accounts, a company is small if it meets two of three tests: turnover up to £15 million, balance sheet up to £7.5 million and up to 50 employees; medium-sized up to £54 million, £27 million and 250 employees. These limits apply to financial years starting on or after 6 April 2025.

Ascentium SME pricing

If your company, assessed together with any linked group companies, meets the official SME definition above, you qualify for Ascentium SME fares and the AI platform. Larger groups are served by Ascentium for Enterprise at ascentium.com.

5. Documents to gather

- ☐ **Name and service address for each director**
- ☐ **Identity verification for directors and PSCs**
- ☐ **Registered office address**
- ☐ **Share structure and initial shareholders**
- ☐ **SIC code describing the business**

6. How Ascentium helps

AI compliance dashboard	A live compliance score for every entity, with each filing, deadline and document in one view.
Ascentia, AI voice assistant	Ask about your status, deadlines or a change, 24/7, and get a qualified expert when judgement is needed.
Premium Economy fare	Formation, registered office, confirmation statement, bookkeeping, annual accounts and the CT600 from £690 a year.
Switching is easy	Moving from another provider? We take over registers and records and file the change for you.